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Rapunzel and Ella's Magical Hair Salon

Author:
Stephanie Christensen

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Rapunzel and Ella's Magical Hair Salon

Duo-FF-Dramedy

By Stephanie Christensen

Rapunzel [singing to herself and dancing around majestically]: La la la la la! [makes eye contact with an audience member] OH! Hello there! The hair salon doesn't open for another hour, but WOW, you look like you could use a hairdresser. [gasps] I mean that in the nicest way possible!!! I haven't quite mastered social interactions yet. Come in, come in! We'll make an exception for you early.

My name is Rapunzel. Welcome to our Magical Hair Salon in the heart of the most magical place on earth… Bronx, New York! Just listen to the sound of people road rage yelling in the street. It's so wonderful, isn't it? [listens to audience as if audience asked a question]

How did this salon get started? Well that's an engaging story! [Ella, other duo partner, comes out from behind Rapunzel] Oh, perfect timing! This is my partner, her name is Cinderella!

Ella [strong New York accent]: Tsk tsk, Rapunzel! What did I tell you about telling strangers my ugly full name?!? My name is Ella. Cut the Cinder pigeon poo part. No cinder. No Isabella. No Cruella. Just Ella.

Rapunzel [upset]: I am so sorry, Ella! I always forget that you're sensitive about that. [to audience member, whispers] She cleaned the floors at Grand Central Station for a few years, that's where the "Cinder" came from.

Ella: RAPUNZEL!

Rapunzel: SORRY!!! Ella, this customer is asking about our story.

Ella [chewing gum, sassy New Yorker]: HA! You better hold onto your behind. You'll be here for hours if you want to hear a story as convoluted as ours. Rapunzel doesn't like to leave out any little detail.

Rapunzel: Oh, look at their hair, Ella! They'll be here for hours anyways.

Ella: THAT'S for sure.

Rapunzel: It all started when I was living alone in a meadow in the middle of Montana…

Ella: RURAL Montana!

Rapunzel: I was just a girl with two dreams… to meet a living, breathing homo sapien.

Ella: That sounds weird out of context, but she grew up among racoons and elk.

Rapunzel: And to open the WORLD'S BEST HAIR SALON so that everyone could have as luscious, long, flowing locks as mine!!!

Ella: She has a few magic ingredients that can really make your hair shine. See, me, I wasn't into the hair industry before I met this goofy go-getter. But, I promise you, all of her hair products are organic. Straight from the forest. In a few words… we'll make ya feel like a princess—

Rapunzel [interjecting]: AT RAPUNZEL AND ELLA'S MAGICAL HAIR SALON!

INTRO

[Flashback to Rapunzel living in a meadow in Montana; duo partners can act out scenes, like Rapunzel rolling in the meadow or running from a bear]

Rapunzel: Back in Montana where I was abandoned at birth, I spent my days rolling around in the flowers of the meadow and my nights hiding in the trees from hungry Montana bears! To stay alive, I would wander into the forest to find a flowing river of water or some beetles and berries for grub.

Ella: Picture it… this gorgeous blonde-haired Tarzan swinging from tree to tree, dodging bears and chomping on beetles!

Rapunzel: The forest creatures became my friends.

[interrupting the flashback, returned to reality in the hair salon]

Ella: Wild animals don't just become your friends, Rapunzel.

Rapunzel: Well. I killed them first. Then, I was able to brush, braid, and style their hair and fur as I pleased!

Ella [notices customer looks uncomfortable]: Oh don't you worry, her killing days are over!

Rapunzel: The only thing killer about me now is my killer dye jobs!

Ella: And MY killer marketing skills!

Rapunzel: Sometimes I still have the urge.

Ella [changing the subject]: One day, she'd had enough of braiding on small subjects, so she made a plan to crawl out of the woods to civilization.

Rapunzel: I embarked on an adventure!

Ella: Now, I don't know how she got here because she never tells me the details. But somehow, this shiny-headed damsel trekked her way 2,000 miles to the heart of the city.

Rapunzel [shivers]: I don't wish that journey upon anyone.

Ella: What did you do, Rapunzel? Ride a bear? MegaBus? Hitchhike with strangers?

Rapunzel: Oh, far worse than any of those transportations.

Ella: Anyhow… she came flying into Manhattan like that Will Ferrell guy in that one Christmas movie, all wide-eyed and naïve.

Rapunzel: Oh I love that movie! I would really like to meet the Elf and discuss shared experiences.

Ella [whispers]: she still hasn't mastered the idea of fictional Hollywood movies yet… [normal voice] So, now to the possibly even MORE tragic story: mine!

Rapunzel: Oh no! Her story is not as bad as she makes it sound.

Ella: Rapunzel wouldn't know a thing about this, but I went to college at NYU. The best 4 years of wasting thousands of dollars in my whole life. I majored in marketing, got a 4.0, and prepared for a life of glorious ladder climbing. My parents from the Bronx were so proud of me.

Rapunzel: Can you imagine? Having PARENTS???

Ella: That brings me to the day I met Rapunzel… I was a home-bound postgrad. I managed to land one job as a custodian at Grand Central Station. From there, I got a job as an office cleaner, doing every chore imaginable for a big-shot marketing firm: sweeping the floor, refilling the coffee, filing restraining orders against anyone who accused us of deceptive marketing tactics. And my job only paid my 0.000002 Bitcoin per hour for my labor!

Rapunzel: Meanwhile, I was learning how to use a crosswalk for the first time.

Ella: She was getting hit by a car.

Rapunzel: I was ABOUT to get hit by a car!

Ella: And of course, she's surrounded by busy New Yorkers who don't ever look up from their phones. But me—I've got reflexes like a swift rat. Or a pigeon, flying to the rescue. And I saw the whole scene go down, so I rushed in, and pulled her out of the way!

Rapunzel: She was my prince charming!

[Flashback to them meeting for the first time in NYC]

Ella [in the flashback]: What are ya DOIN?!? I'm walking here! Minding my business! When I see this blonde goddess about to get mowed down by a taxi! Girl, I've never seen hair as beautiful as yours. You can't let a tire tread on that!

Rapunzel: Oh WOW! Thank you! How did you know what that big machine was? Do you live here, on this corner?

Ella: Uhh… I live with my parents.

Rapunzel: Wonderful! I live in a meadow! Well, I did. Now I live in something called a commune in Brooklyn. They took me in as long as I agreed to model for their apartment's advertisement.

Ella: Wow, I wish I was THAT gorgeous to get a deal like that.

Rapunzel: Are your eyes blinded by pollen and spider webs?! Your hair is INCREDIBLE! I have never seen such bouncy curls before in my life. The hair I usually work on is coarse. Occasionally covered in ticks.

Ella [confused, grossed out]: What do you do?

Rapunzel: Oh, I am a hairdresser! I just learned that term a few days ago.

Ella: Really? How long have you been in New York?

Rapunzel: About a week. This city is very big so I am only able to walk about 20 miles per day. I have never seen trees as tall as these glass ones.

Ella: This is your first week as a hairdresser in New York??? And you've been WALKING the city? Whoa, whoa whoa, I think we need to get you on a subway.

[Flash forward to the hair salon]

Rapunzel: And she took me on my first SUBWAY RIDE!!! That was the best day of my life!

Ella: It was the day that changed everything. Rapunzel needed help starting and marketing her business. And I thought I could become a self-made entrepreneur millionaire by helping her, like all the famous Tik Tok millionaires nowadays.

Rapunzel: Ella and I rode the subway UNDERGROUND at LIGHTNING SPEED! We ate a pizza that was much better than beetles and berries. And we saw a man dancing with a rubber chicken on the street!

Ella: That is where it all began. I taught her the in's and out's. We got to work printing and distributing brochures immediately. Soon, my whole neighborhood in Bronx learned about Rapunzel's hair talents.

Rapunzel: Ella came up with an amazing saying—Rapunzel and Ella's Magical Hair Salon: Where you can get a hairstyle that makes you feel like a princess!

Ella: We eventually shortened it to "we'll make ya feel like a princess!" But poor Rapunzel… we went through some rough times to get here.

Rapunzel [apprehensive]: Our customer doesn't need to hear about that.

Ella: Securing and affording a storefront like this wasn't easy work. And I think everyone should know that, Rapunzel.

[duo partners transition to the last flashback]

Rapunzel: It was about a year and 3 months after I had arrived in New York City.

Ella: At this point, Rapunzel and I were operating successfully out of my parents' living room. She had grown close to her ladies at the commune, and occasionally we would host big events there for the nuns.

Rapunzel: I had managed to retrieve and store all of my natural hair ingredients from the meadow. Some days in the big, noisy city, I missed that place more than I could imagine.

Ella: There was one night where Rapunzel and I had to work late at my house. She forgot to wear shoes when she came over to my house.

Rapunzel: In the forest, I was always barefoot.

Ella: So I let her borrow some of my slippers for the subway ride home. Maybe around midnight, it was time for her to leave. She insisted on going alone.

Rapunzel: On my walk to the subway, I heard a stranger's voice. [Ella steps behind Rapunzel and then comes out hunched over, as Rumpelstiltskin]

Rumpelstiltskin: Hey. Psstt! You there with the hair like golden straw!

Rapunzel [looks around, confused]: Huh? Me?

Rumpelstiltskin: Come closer! I've got some watches that you'll really want to buy.

Rapunzel: Oh no thank you, sir! I don't need a watch to know I'm having a good time!

Rumpelstiltskin: But I need you to buy a watch. I'll have no money otherwise if you don't.

Rapunzel: That is very sad to hear! Can you maybe go to the bank and get some? My friend Ella and I did that, and we'll find out in a couple days if they will give us money for our hair salon!

Rumpelstiltskin [inches closer]: Ahhh, a hair salon? I say. You must be a very smart girl. How about you and I make a deal, hmm?

Rapunzel [nervously looks for the subway, then looks back at him]: A deal like what?

Rumpelstiltskin: If you buy twelve of these watches before their tickers strike twelve, I'll give you a storefront of your own for free!

Rapunzel: A storefront for free? Well that sounds magical! But I don't have any money to buy your watches, sir!

Rumpelstiltskin: Oh you'll buy these watches, whether you want to or not!! [Lunges for her and grabs her. Duo partners should enact a near-touch scene where the one playing Rumpelstiltskin hover grabs Rapunzel. This should give opportunity for unique tech.] GIVE ME YOUR PURSE! And don't try to scream!!

Rapunzel [screaming to an empty subway station]: HELP! PLEASE, SOMEONE HELP!! [tries to wrestle out of his grip] Get off of me! Let go of my bag! PLEASE, SIR! The subway is here now, please let me get on it.

Rumpelstiltskin [grabbing her hair]: If you don't give me your bag, I will cut off all of this golden blonde hair and throw it in the sewers!

[Rapunzel breaks away, throwing her bag at him and losing one slipper, as she makes a beeline for the subway]

Rapunzel: Absolutely not!! Ow, my hair! Get away from me!

[Flashforward to hair salon]

Ella: That night, one of the nuns at the commune called me about what happened. Rapunzel was pretty shaken up when she got home. She threatened to cut off her beautiful hair.

Rapunzel: My life was worth more than my hair. And I never thought I would have to choose between those.

Ella: So, I had my father travel with me over to the commune. I sat with Rapunzel at her desk, and helped her cut it and style it myself.

Rapunzel: We created the beautiful, healthy, functioning blonde bob you see today!

Ella: It threw a wrench in her confidence. Rapunzel and I had to go over safety in the city and set new limits on what she could do alone.

Rapunzel: In the meadow, I was responsible for my own destiny. I knew how to avoid the predators— the bears who could tear me apart. When I finally met humans like me, I never knew they could do the same thing.

Ella: I slept over that night. Rapunzel told me about her life in the meadow.

Rapunzel: The yellow blossoms. Grass that made your nose itch but your heart soar to the clouds. Fresh air, with no smog or fog or cigarette smoke.

Ella: We found joy talking about such a welcoming, flower-y place. And we knew that was the atmosphere we would create here, at our salon, if we'd ever make it a reality.

Rapunzel: She sang me to sleep that night, actually.

Ella: Hey! We can't let people know I have a soft side. I'm kind of like your NYC protector, Rapunzel.

Rapunzel: You and me Ella. La la la la la la…

Ella: And the next morning, we woke up to a voicemail in my phone inbox. It was the bank, telling us we had been granted the loan for our storefront.

Rapunzel: Our magical hair salon! Our hair haven!

Ella: So welcome in… and thanks for trudging up a story I haven't thought about in a few years.

Rapunzel: Here, we'll make ya feel like a princess.

Ella: Or a dead forest animal. Either way, with a bangin' new hairdo.